CLIENT ACQUISITION STRATEGY

Who to sell to, what to say, and what never to say

DeepGrid Semi · commercial lead briefing · built on the July-corrected basis

Oct 2026 is the real deadline

2 tracks

5 banned claims

whitespace closing

Sell Track A now on proof you already hold; validate Track B against a clock

Executive summary — the commercial answer

BLUF The mandate wave that matters commercially is October 2026 — existing production models — not the April date the decks lead with. And the low-BOM vertically-integrated whitespace is closing about 18 months earlier than assumed. Both push the same conclusion: sell what is provable now, and put a date on what is not.

Track A — sell now

Sovereign defence, border surveillance and port AGV. On-die HSM, Indian-designed, shipping on FPGA today. Backed by ₹1 Cr defence revenue and a GeM record — the only line that needs neither the certificate nor the tapeout.

Track B — validate, don't promise

3PL and dedicated fleet retrofit against the Oct 2026 deadline. Positioning is marked PENDING VALIDATION in your own deck. Twenty buyer interviews, one paid pilot, 90 days — or the statement is retracted.

The clock that changed

Netrasemi went production-ready in May 2026 with three OEM trials, on ₹107 Cr. Your July map placed them in 2027. The head-start is shorter than the 30-month runway assumes.

Discipline rule from the July deck, unchanged: the retrofit-price line never appears in a defence conversation, and the sovereign-data line never appears in a fleet one.

SECTION 01

The demand clock

When the buyer is actually forced to act

October 2026 is the deadline that creates buyers — not April

GSR 184(E) is phased; the decks lead with the wrong date

When	What	Scope	Status
March 2025	GSR 184(E) notified	AIS-162/184/186/187/188 for M2, M3, N2, N3	Done
April 2026	New models must comply	Applies to newly introduced models only	Passed
October 2026	Existing production models	The volume wave — every model in production	2 months
2027 – Jan 2028	Further systems phase in	Additional ADAS functions layered on	Runway

Why this changes the pitch

April 2026 only bound new model introductions — a small population. October 2026 binds everything already in production. That is when fleet and OEM buyers are actually forced to move, and it is eight weeks away.

The uncomfortable corollary

AIS certification is a path, not held. If the October wave lands before certification does, the buyer who is forced to act cannot buy from DeepGrid — they buy the compliance box. Track A does not have this problem.

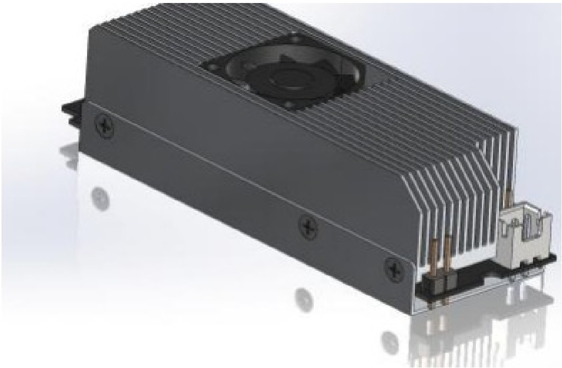
VERIFIED *Phasing confirmed independently, Aug 2026 · electraytech.com; novushitech.com*

What you are selling: a certified system, not a chip

One six-chiplet 28nm die underneath four product lines

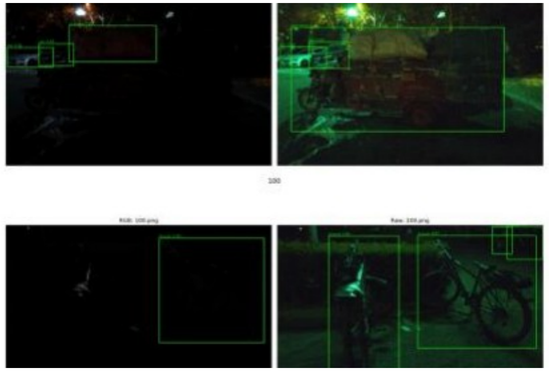
DGrid Alpha module

M.2 form factor



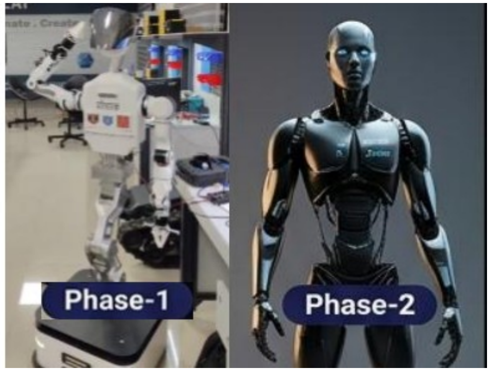
A100 compute box

1ch / 2ch / 4ch



D-Drive perception

transformer VLA, no HD maps



Phase-3 autonomy

yards, ports, defence

Line	Product	Price	What it is for commercially
AD0	Smart mirror / 360	₹0.50L	Retrofit entry — the upgrade-ladder foot in the door
AD2	Full truck ADAS kit	₹2.0–2.5L	The mandate product — compute + software + sensors
AD4	Off-highway autonomy	₹0.45–3.5 Cr	Private land: yards, ports, defence — no FMVSS, no cert gate

TSMC 28nm HPC+ · 39.3 TOPS INT8 · 64 PCOREs · ~57.1 mm² die · 8.6 ms of a 33.3 ms frame budget (74% headroom)

Why owning the silicon is the argument — in a buyer's language

Four claims, each of which a competitor cannot simply match

Cost — the one they feel

₹2L kit against ₹6.5–15L imports, because the die is ~$30 of board BOM rather than a bought-in $6,000-class part. A merchant incumbent cannot shrink to that without cannibalising its own margin.

Capability — the one they test

Heavy transformer VLA models run on-chip. A YOLO-class edge part cannot host them. This is the claim to lead with in a fleet room, because the ₹30,000 box has no answer.

India-fit — the one they believe

Models and 12-bit radar trained on Indian road data — cattle, autos, unmarked lanes. A foreign chip vendor cannot reach that data, and every Indian fleet operator already knows why it matters.

Control — the one procurement asks

Indigenous supply, no import dependence, on-die HSM. In government and defence procurement this stops being a feature and becomes an eligibility criterion.

Sequence matters: capability opens a fleet conversation, control opens a defence one, and cost closes both. Cost never opens.

SECTION 02

Who to sell to

Two tracks, two proof burdens, never the same room

Six segments, five reachable — and only two worth this quarter

Where the ₹2.3L price holds and where it does not

Segment	Why it is addressable	Does ₹2.3L hold?	Priority
Government / PSU / defence	Foreign silicon excluded; GeM record already held	Yes, at a premium	TRACK A — now
Plant and yard operators	Own the land and the vehicles; become the Phase-3 customer	Yes	TRACK A — now
Large organised fleets (50+)	Real safety P&L, single decision-maker, can run a pilot	Yes	TRACK B — validate
OEM / Tier-1 line-fit	One relationship covers thousands of vehicles	Yes — the volume engine	Start now, closes late
3PL and freight aggregators	Aggregate small operators into one contract	Partly — will negotiate hard	Later
Sub-five-truck owner-operators	~3.5M operators, no purchasing process, hard price anchor	No — needs channel and a cheaper SKU	Not addressable

The two highlighted rows need neither the certificate nor the tapeout

That is the whole reason they are this quarter's targets. Every other segment is gated on something DeepGrid does not yet hold, and selling into a gate you cannot open burns the relationship you will need later.

Who actually signs, and what each of them is afraid of

Buyer committee by track — the fear is what you sell against

TRACK A · defence / PSU / yard

Role	What they fear
Programme / procurement officer	Foreign dependency and audit exposure
Security or data officer	Exfiltration — answered physically by on-die HSM
Operations lead	A pilot that disrupts a working site
Finance	A capital line with no precedent to compare

TRACK B · 3PL / dedicated fleet

Role	What they fear
Fleet owner / promoter	Spending ₹2.3L when ₹30k passes inspection
Safety / compliance head	Being non-compliant in October
Finance / NBFC partner	Capital outlay without a payback story
Driver / union	Surveillance framing of driver monitoring

The two hardest people in the room

In Track A it is the security officer — and they are the easiest to win, because on-die HSM is a physical answer rather than a policy assurance. In Track B it is the driver and the union: driver monitoring reads as surveillance unless it is introduced as protection from false blame. Get that framing wrong once and the pilot dies on the shop floor rather than in the boardroom.

Track A — sovereign defence and off-highway: sell this now

Primary track · the only line needing neither the certificate nor the tapeout

POSITIONING STATEMENT

“For sovereign UGV, border-surveillance and port-AGV programs where data cannot leave Indian soil, DGrid Alpha is the only Indian-designed combo-die whose on-die HSM makes data-exfil physically impossible — shipping today on FPGA, ASIC drop-in next.”

Why it closes

Data sovereignty is a procurement rule, not a preference. Foreign silicon is excluded from government fleets outright, so the comparison set is small and the on-die HSM is a physical answer rather than a policy promise.

What you can prove today

₹1 Cr defence revenue booked · a GeM record already held · perception running on FPGA at measured 40fps. None of this waits on AIS certification or the 28nm tapeout.

Kill criterion — from your own deck

Track drops from primary if Month 6 arrives without either a second signed contract, or audited confirmation of the ₹1 Cr revenue's commercial nature.

Track B — fleet retrofit: run it as an experiment, not a promise

Secondary track · your own deck marks this PENDING VALIDATION

POSITIONING STATEMENT · PENDING VALIDATION

“For N2/N3 fleet operators facing 2027–28 ADAS mandate deadlines, DGrid Alpha ships one retrofit kit that satisfies AEBS, LDW, DMS and BSD at roughly 1/3 the imported-stack price — pending first paid pilot.”

Why it is not yet sellable as stated

No paid pilot has closed. The price claim is real against imports and irrelevant against the ₹15–40k compliance box that satisfies the same inspector. Nothing in the documents shows a buyer who chose ₹2.3L over ₹30,000.

What makes it convert

Not price. The buyer must want capability — which means the conversation is about what a compliance box cannot do: transformer perception, driver monitoring, and a certified latency budget on one part.

Kill criterion — from your own deck

The statement is retracted from decks, site and sales collateral if the first 20 buyer interviews fail to produce one paid pilot in 90 days.

One story per buyer — the two tracks never meet

Positioning discipline · carried unchanged from the July deck

IN A DEFENCE ROOM

Say: data sovereignty, on-die HSM, Indian-designed, shipping on FPGA, GeM record, ₹1 Cr booked.

Never say: the retrofit price line, the 1/3-of-imports comparison, fleet ROI, or anything about insurance.

IN A FLEET ROOM

Say: mandate deadline, one kit covers AEBS/LDW/DMS/BSD, install time, capability the cheap box cannot match.

Never say: sovereign data, HSM exfiltration, defence customers, or anything implying a government-only product.

Why this matters more than it sounds

A blurred positioning statement reads as a company that has not chosen. A defence buyer who hears a fleet-price pitch concludes the product is a commodity; a fleet buyer who hears a sovereignty pitch concludes it is not for them. The two stories are individually strong and jointly weak.

Five claims you may not make — and what to say instead

Enforced from the July deck · unreconciled math, unmeasured effect, or forecast-as-demand

#	Banned claim	Why	Use instead
01	“84% ASIC gross margin”	Unreconciled arithmetic — retracted until reconciled	“Chip-level margin curve; blended systems margin FY32 88%. We publish the arithmetic.”
02	Any insurance-premium-reduction %	No actuarial partner, no signed data-share, no baseline	Silence — until a pilot produces a delta an insurer will co-sign
03	“Mandate-ready” for AD2	Not mapped 1:1 to chiplets in a public homologation doc	“AIS-184/186/187/188 addressable by design; AIS-140 native via S100.”
04	Any accident-reduction %	Nothing measured — no fleet baseline exists yet	“Pilot design targets a measurable delta; here is the measurement plan.”
05	“5M+ truck TAM” as pipeline	TAM ≠ SAM ≠ SOM ≠ pipeline	“TAM 5M+; addressable at our BOM ~1.2M; pipeline is what has a name.”

The June IM still contains four of these five

It leads with “84% gross margin”, “<$3 die”, “5M+ Trucks” as a headline metric and “₹2–2.5L mandate-ready kit”. If that document is still in circulation, withdraw it — it contradicts your own corrections ledger.

What you can put in front of a buyer today

The proof kit — and the honest gaps beside it

Asset	State	How to use it
₹1 Cr defence revenue	CONTRACTED	Strongest single asset. Track A only
GeM record	CONTRACTED	Procurement eligibility already established
DGS001 module running on FPGA	SILICON	Live demo — perception measured at 40fps
YOLOv11n at 40fps on FPGA	MEASURED	A number you may quote; it was measured
15 provisional patents filed Mar 2026	FILED	Filed, not granted — say filed
Carla-validated D-Drive loop	VALIDATION	Simulation, not road. Say so
AIS-162/188 certification	NOT HELD	A path via NATRAX. Never imply otherwise
28nm ASIC silicon	ROADMAP	Tapes out ~Q1–mid 2027. FPGA ships today
Fleet accident-reduction data	NONE	No baseline exists. Banned claim #4
Insurer premium-reduction data	NONE	No actuarial partner. Banned claim #2

The top three sell Track A today. The bottom four are why Track B is an experiment and not a pipeline.

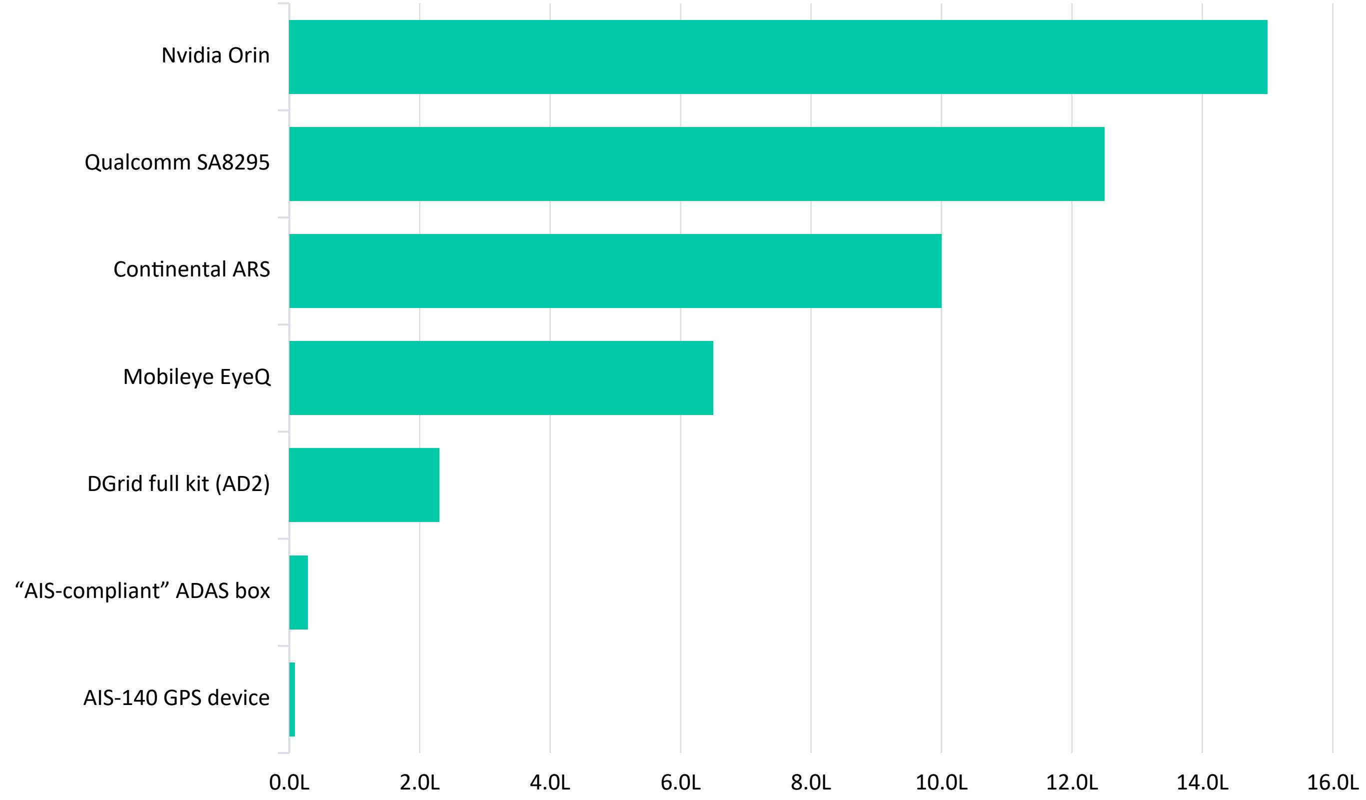
SECTION 03

The competitive ground

What you are actually being compared against

Two contests, not one — and only one of them is won

The price ladder the buyer actually sees



How to use this in a room

Against imports: you win, 2.8–6.5×. This contest is already settled and does not need re-arguing.

Against the compliance box: you are ~20× the ₹4,500–11,000 anchor. Price is not an argument you can win here.

So never open a fleet conversation on price. Open on what the ₹30,000 box physically cannot do — transformer perception, driver monitoring, and a certified latency budget on one part.

The import comparison is for OEM and Tier-1 rooms, where the incumbent bid actually is ₹6.5L+.

VERIFIED *AIS-140 street pricing confirmed independently Aug 2026; import prices per company deck, not independently benchmarked*

The whitespace is closing about 18 months earlier than mapped

Finding · verified independently this week · this is new information

Player	July deck position	What is true in Aug 2026	Evidence state
Netrasemi	Mapped "(2027)" in the July deck	A2000 production-ready May 2026 · 3 OEM trials live incl. automotive · ₹107 Cr Series A led by Zoho	Validation
Netrasemi A4000	Not mapped	Edge-AI server chip targeting fab readiness Q2 2027	Roadmap
RoshAI	Mapped as software-first	Raised ₹22 Cr for autonomous vehicles in industrial use — adjacent to Phase-3 yards	Validation
Mobileye	Import comparison only	Selected by Mahindra for ADAS across six future models	Production

What this does to the runway thesis

Slide 25 of the July deck says the whitespace has a shelf life and that by 2027–28 at least one peer becomes a real competitor. That is arriving early. Netrasemi is production-ready now, on roughly twice the capital DeepGrid is raising.

But read the evidence state carefully

Netrasemi's A2000 is an edge-AI SoC for video analytics across IoT, healthcare and surveillance — automotive is one target sector, not the product. It is not a certified ADAS combo-die with drive-by-wire. The whitespace narrowed; it did not close.

SECTION 04

Running the motion

Objections, channel, and the next 90 days

The five objections you will hear, and the honest answer

Battlecards · every answer stays inside the banned-claims rules

Objection	The answer
“A ₹30,000 box passes the same inspection.”	Correct today, while enforcement is transitional. It cannot do transformer perception, driver monitoring or a certified latency budget. Move to capability, never argue price.
“Are you actually AIS certified?”	No — certification is a path, not held. Say so plainly and point to the NATRAX route. Never say “mandate-ready”.
“Why not Mobileye? Mahindra chose them.”	True, and for OEM line-fit they have the relationships. Our ground is indigenous supply, sovereign data, and price at 2.8–6.5× below — strongest where foreign silicon is excluded.
“What premium reduction will my insurer give?”	We do not have an actuarial partner or a measured baseline, so we will not quote a number. Here is the pilot measurement plan instead.
“What if you don't tape out?”	The FPGA product ships today and Track A revenue does not depend on the tapeout. The ASIC changes cost, not capability.

Every one of these concedes something true. That is deliberate — a conceded weakness buys credibility for the claim that follows it.

Channel is the business model, not a sales motion

Dealers, NBFCs and insurers — and the one thing you cannot yet say

Dealers — reach

The only way to touch operators below the organised segment. 75–80% of operators own fewer than five trucks and cannot be sold to directly at any sane acquisition cost.

NBFCs — affordability

They already finance the truck. Financing the kit alongside it converts a ₹2.3L capital decision into a monthly line, which is the only framing in which the compliance-box comparison stops mattering.

Insurers — the unlock, unquantified

An insurer subsidising part of the kit against a premium discount is the strongest commercial idea in the plan. It is also where banned claim #2 applies: no percentage may be quoted until a pilot produces a delta an insurer co-signs.

How to sell the insurer motion without quoting a number

Sell the mechanism, not the outcome: “we instrument the fleet, we measure the delta, and we bring your insurer the data.” That is a real offer, it is fully supportable today, and it sets up the actuarial partnership that eventually makes the percentage sayable. Quoting a number now costs you the partnership later.

The next 90 days

Sequenced so the October wave is not missed

#	Action	When	Why now
1	Withdraw the June IM from circulation	Week 1	It repeats four banned claims
2	Second defence contract — Track A proof	Weeks 1–8	Kill criterion is Month 6; do not wait
3	20 fleet buyer interviews, 1 paid pilot	Weeks 1–12	Track B kill criterion, already dated
4	Certification status letter for buyers	Week 2	Removes the “are you certified” fudge
5	One NBFC and one insurer conversation	Weeks 2–6	Sell the measurement mechanism, no %
6	Re-map the whitespace against Netrasemi	Week 3	The 2027 assumption no longer holds
7	OEM/Tier-1 first meeting	Weeks 4–12	BP-1A concedes no contact exists yet

Items 2 and 3 are the two kill criteria your own deck already set. Everything else exists to make those two land.

What would change this strategy

Kill criteria and watch items

Trigger	What it means	Source
No second defence contract by Month 6	Track A drops from primary	Your own kill criterion
No paid fleet pilot in 90 days	Track B statement is retracted everywhere	Your own kill criterion
AIS certification slips past October 2026	The forced-buyer wave goes to compliance boxes	New — from the mandate phasing
Netrasemi announces a certified ADAS part	The differentiated position closes, not narrows	New — watch quarterly
An insurer declines the measurement pilot	The channel's affordability answer weakens	Channel dependency

The one-line summary

Sell Track A now on proof that already exists, run Track B as a dated experiment, withdraw the June IM today, and treat the October wave as the deadline it actually is. The differentiated position is real — it is just worth less every quarter it goes unconverted.